

MACHINATIONS & ACTIONS: 5e

First Divine Dossier - Catalogue of the Author



VOLTAIRE THE BLACK

Recorded by the subject, who is also the patron, witness, and jurisdiction.

Declaration of Subject

I, Voltaire, catalogue myself.

This is the first dossier of my declared divinity. It is written in the first person because all honest scripture eventually is.

Status: living; self-patroned; Divine Rank 1; awaiting formal execution of the First Rite.



*If this page blinks,
blink back. I cannot.*

*Age is accurate in
years, not in recent
subjective months.*

*Alignment: neutral to
whom?*

*The crab is a
co-author when
convenient.*

*Do not add a halo.
Halos imply
overhead.*

ENTRY	CATALOGUED VALUE
Name	Voltaire the Black
Player	Dicfuc
Present species	Variant Human - formerly a Fae Prince
Class	Rogue 5 (Thief) / Warlock 8 (Archfey)
Background	Hermit
Alignment	Chaotic Neutral
Level / Experience	13 / 122,783 of 140,000 XP
Faith	Self Worship
Divine office	Rank 1; proposed Domain of Unbecoming

Physical inventory of the god-body

Age: 30. Height: 185 cm (6 ft. 1 in.). Weight: 185 lb before equipment, divine gravitas, or argumentative crab.

Hair: dark. Skin: pale/white, extensively tattooed. Eyes: brown, perpetually open, and inclined to notice red eyes where others report empty space.

The mouth smiles continuously because frowning hurts. A living crab-soul grimoire is grafted to a donkey-like tail. A V has been carved into the chest and forehead by Shadar-kai initiates.

A History of Becoming Incorrectly

I. The Fall

I was Prince of the Swamp until visiting bards mistook the Deck of Many Things for a social activity. The King of Spades and Ace of Clubs cast me into the Michaca desert, changed my Fae nature into humanity, and took most of my memories.

I objected to the desert. The desert did not apologise.

II. The Transcription

Greg accelerated me with a Potion of Haste and had me read the Book of Vile Darkness and the Book of Exalted Deeds. I survived both, transcribed them into a unified work, and learned every language without noticing that I had done so.

Good and evil are therefore reference sections.

No one warned me that cards were geography.



Mask's hollow statue: occupied vacancy, six subjective months.

III. The Sun, the Ink, and the Tail

The Sun Card became both weapon and generative principle. The Ink of Unbeing taught memory to behave like material. My ritual book acquired a crab soul, skins, blood-inks, opinions, and eventually my tail.

Robin emerged when a following frog received the Sun Card and reality rolled well.

Universal language: the only proficiency with no sensible dropdown.

IV. Rank One

Roughly twenty Shadar-kai marked me with V, admitted me to the tower, and dedicated themselves. I destroyed the hollow statue of dethroned Mask, stood in its place, and was recorded as Divine Rank 1.

This is not the end of the argument. It is the first numbered footnote.

Mask left a vacancy. I brought posture.

Two events suitable for official forms

Notable Event One - The Fall from Grace: dispossession, desert exile, human transformation, and loss of the swamp-prince memory.

Notable Event Two - The Ascension of V: Shadar-kai recognition, destruction of Mask's hollow statue, and attainment of Divine Rank 1.

Twelve subjective months now live between lines.

Numerical Proof of Existence



Intelligence is 19 because the headband agrees with me.

MEASURE	VALUE	ANNOTATION
Armour Class	19	12 base +4 Dex +2 enhancement +1 Ring
Maximum HP	100	13d8 total class Hit Dice
Initiative	+4	Dexterity
Speed	30 ft.	Climbing costs no extra movement
Passive senses	19 / 9 / 14	Perception / Insight / Investigation
Darkvision	120 ft.	Robe-assisted, as recorded
Proficiency	+5	Level 13
Carrying	105 / 210 / 230 lb.	Capacity / push-drag-lift / actually carried

Performance is +10. Previous scribes were wrong. This is now doctrine.

SAVE	TOTAL	STATUS
Strength	-1	Ring +1
Dexterity	+10	Prof. + Ring
Constitution	+4	Ring +1
Intelligence	+10	Prof. + Ring
Wisdom	+0	Ring +1
Charisma	+6	Ring +1

SKILL	MOD	SKILL	MOD
Acrobatics	+9	Animal Handling	-1
Arcana	+4	Athletics	-2
Deception	+5	History	+4
Insight	-1	Intimidation	+5
Investigation	+4	Medicine	+4
Nature	+4	Perception	+9
Performance	+10	Persuasion	+5
Religion	+9	Sleight of Hand	+9
Stealth	+14	Survival	-1

230 lb carried on a 105 lb capacity. Gravity has filed a complaint.

Movement curiosities

Running long jump: approximately 11 ft. Running high jump: approximately 5 ft. Second-Story Work supplies the extra 4 ft.; standing jumps are halved. Crawling ordinarily uses half speed.

Wisdom remains economical.

Instruments, Advantages, and Other Limbs



The crab-book tail

A sentient ritual grimoire of stitched skins and varied blood-inks, invested with a crab soul and grafted into my tail.

It consumes skin to absorb memories, writes prophecies or lies, and serves as spellbook, companion, archive, and editorial dispute.

The tail counts as an additional body part because forms fear imagination.

ROGUE / THIEF	WARLOCK / ARCHFEY
Sneak Attack 3d6	Pact Magic: two 4th-level slots
Expertise: Stealth, Perception	Spell DC 18; attack +10
Cunning Action; Steady Aim	Agonizing Blast
Fast Hands; Second-Story Work	Aspect of the Moon
Uncanny Dodge	Mask of Many Faces
Thieves' Cant	Feral Transformation
	Fey Presence; Misty Escape
	Pact of the Tome

The Robe has eyes. I have eyes. Management remains contested.

BODY / SLOT	RECORDED IMPLEMENT
Head	Headband of Intellect
Garment	Robe of Eyes
Armour	+2 Studded Leather
Shoulders	Cape of Darkness
Finger	Ring of Protection
Hands / weapons	Two Shadow Daggers +2; Chakram +6; shortbow
Additional body part	Donkey-like tail and living Crab Book
Pack	Thieves' tools, herbalism kit, poles, ropes, light, oil, ball bearings, improbable trophies

Ball bearings: portable terrain.

Feats and trained languages

Feats: Fey Touched; Lucky; Shadow Touched. Armour: light. Weapons: hand crossbow, longsword, rapier, shortsword, simple weapons. Tools: herbalism kit, thieves' tools.

Languages: Abyssal, Common, Elvish, Thieves' Cant, and All. The final entry is neither exaggeration nor sensible.

The Sun Card is both equipment and ancestor.

Practiced Impossibilities

PACT MAGIC	VALUE
Spellcasting ability	Charisma
Spell save DC	18
Spell attack	+10
Pact slots	2 slots, each 4th level
At will	Disguise Self



Two slots. Fourth level. The economy of miracles.

LEVEL	SPELLS
Cantrips	Eldritch Blast; Blade Ward; Mage Hand; Guidance; Booming Blade; Word of Radiance
1st	Armor of Agathys; Expeditious Retreat; Hex; Sleep; Silent Image; Disguise Self
2nd	Shadow Blade; Darkness; Suggestion; Misty Step; Invisibility
3rd	Hypnotic Pattern
4th	Greater Invisibility; Summon Greater Demon

Disguise Self is at will. Identity is therefore a wardrobe problem.

Favourite buttons

Action: Hypnotic Pattern; Suggestion; Greater Invisibility; Feral Transformation; or the ordinary violence of Eldritch Blast.

Bonus action: Cunning Action; Fast Hands; Misty Step; Shadow Blade; Hex.

Reaction: Uncanny Dodge or Misty Escape.

Concentration is singular

Only one of Greater Invisibility, Invisibility, Hypnotic Pattern, Suggestion, Shadow Blade, Hex, Darkness, or Expeditious Retreat may occupy the same thought at once. Theology contains the same defect.

Transformations

Once per long rest I may become a dire wolf, giant spider, or giant octopus for up to one hour. I retain Intelligence, Wisdom, Charisma, speech, saving-throw proficiencies, and verbal-only spellcasting. Current state: giant spider, climbing the tower; use expended until recovery.

Never concentrate on Hex when theatrics are available.

Octopus remains a theological option.

Theology, Followers, and Jurisdiction



Religious ideology

Divinity is produced through memory, symbol, recognition, and worship freely directed by independent minds. I worship myself and function as my own patron.

Shar is a formative power and an honoured catalyst. Gratitude does not require subordination.

My emerging sphere is the Domain of Unbecoming: transformation through the destruction of imposed identity.

A symbol is a door pretending to be a drawing.

Worship that cannot leave is merely furniture.

FOLLOWER / BODY	STATUS
Robin	Disciple; first companion; blessed with V
Two Fae specimens	Memories of prior gods replaced with Voltaire
Shrek	Converted through Ink fine print
Blink Dog	Locally Norhan's; spiritually Voltaire's
~20 Shadar-kai	Confirmed initiates; hierarchy unknown
Bloodweb spiders	Allies or ritual partners; worship unconfirmed

The Followers of V

Provisional organisation-name: The Followers of V. The sigil combines a triangle exceeding a square into a seven-point core, paired eyes, luminous mushroom and hellhound-blood ink, and dark shadowweave filigree.

The mark has been carved into a Shadowfell aspen, where it sank into the bark as though it had always been present. A many-eyed V later manifested remotely within the Temple of Blood.

Shar receives thanks, not ownership.

ALLIES / ASSOCIATES	COMPLICATED OR OPPOSED
The party; Robin; Shadar-kai initiates	Shar - catalyst, rival, not enemy
Greg; Glasya; Bloodweb spiders (provisional)	Corellon - intended confrontation
	Mask - dethroned vacancy; statue destroyed
	Queen of Abeil - hostile authority

Order-name pending. Religions are untidy before stationery.

The First Rite, Not Yet Executed



Prospective plate only: the rite remains unperformed.



Hypothesis: a network awakened by V through the followers' sigil.

PROSPECTIVE. Do not mistake intention for completed miracle.

Declared sequence

1. Reach the tower summit and acknowledge my divinity before the gods.
2. Pray to Shar and thank her for her part in my becoming.
3. Cut Shar's circle-square-triangle geometry into my flesh and let the blood fall upon the tower's highest point.
4. Shape the blood into the Followers of V sigil around the anti-light, then drive V through the design.
5. Call every connected sigil already placed.

Blood is ink that insists on provenance.

PETITION	INTENDED RESULT
Claim	Transform the tower into Voltaire's realm: a threshold between the Feywild and Shar's realm.
Connection	Awaken teleportation between qualified V sigils.

Unresolved theorems for Lachlan

The blood cost, checks, divine witnesses, Shar's response, network limits, permitted travellers, failure state, and precise mechanics of Divine Rank 1 remain unconfirmed.

The Temple of Blood has already manifested many eyes and V at a distance. Whether that event created the first shrine, a claim, or a network anchor is also unresolved.

If every mark becomes a door, remember which side has spiders.

The rite begins when the table says it begins.